VI - Economic Importance of Plants

Exercise 24: Economically important plants

S.No	Identification (Plant name)	Botanical Name	Useful parts	Uses
1	Wheat	*Triticum aestivum*	Whole grain	1. Wheat flour is suitable to make bread and bakery products. 2. Malted wheat is a major raw material for producing alcoholic beverages and nutritive drinks.
2	Black pepper	*Piper nigrum*	Seeds	1. It is used as an aromatic stimulant for enhancing salivary and gastric secretion. 2. Pepper also enhances the bio-absorption of medicine.
3	Cotton	*Gossypium barbadense*	Seed coat fibres	1. It is mainly used in the manufacturing of various textile, hosiery products, toys and is also used in hospitals. 2. Cotton fibres are used in stuffing pillows and cushions.
4	Keezhanelli	*Phyllanthus amarus*	Entire shoot system	Extract of the plant is generally used for the treatment of jaundice
5	Green gram	*Vigna radiata*	Seeds	1. Roasted, cooked or sprouted seeds are edible. 2. Fried, dehulled and broken or whole green gram is used as a popular snack and breakfast dish.
6	Banana	*Musa* x *paradisiaca*	Fruit	1. The banana fruit contains potassium and essential vitamins which can be eaten raw or cooked. 2. The fruit can be processed into flour and can be fermented for the production of beverages such as banana juice, vinegar, beer and vine.

Exercise 25: Economically important plant products

S. no	Identification (Product name)	Botanical Name	Useful parts	Uses
1.	Sesame/ Gingelly oil	*Sesamum indicum*	Seeds	1. Sesame oil is mostly used for culinary purposes. 2. Lower grades are used in manufacture of soaps, in paint industries, as a lubricant and as an illuminant.
2.	Rubber	*Hevea brasiliensis*	Latex	1. Rubber is used in the manufacture of footwear, wire and cable insulations, rain coat, sports goods, erasers, adhesives, rubber bands, household and hospital goods and shock absorbers. 2. Concentrated latex is used for making gloves and balloons. 3. Foamed latex is used in the manufacture of cushions, pillows and life-belts.
3.	Flaked Rice (Aval)	*Oryza sativa*	Seeds	1. Flaked rice (aval) is used as breakfast cereal or as snacks.
4.	Rose Water	*Rosa* x *damascena*	Petals	1. Rose water (panneer) is used in confectionaries, syrups and soft drinks. 2. In India, rose water is much used in eye lotions and eye washes.
5.	Henna Powder	*Lawsonia inermis*	Leaves	1. An orange dye "henna" obtained from leaves and young shoots is used to dye skin, hair and fingernails. 2. It is also used for colouring leather, tails of horses and hair.
6.	Aloe Gel	*Aloe vera*	Leaves	1. Aloe gel is used as skin tonic. 2. Because of its cooling effect and moisturizing characteristics, it is used in the preparation of creams, lotions, shampoos, shaving creams and allied products. 3. It is used in gerontological applications for rejuvenation of ageing skin.

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